

Editorial

Dear readers,

I was not enthused when some of my editorial colleagues started branding the KDE 4.3 compilation, which features in the current LFY CD, as the 'perfect desktop'. Well, for those who use Gmail's voice and video chat—it definitely did not seem like one. Could a desktop that does not facilitate the use of such popular tools, be called 'perfect'? I wasn't sure.

My colleagues, on the other hand, argued that the fault lies with Google for not making the video chat feature available in the Linux version of Firefox, thereby giving people another excuse not to switch to Linux. When you come to think about it, doesn't Google always do this—release stuff for Windows first? But should we keep complaining or work towards getting that feature as a core functionality of an alternate application? Thus, when Google (or any other company, for that matter) finally makes the solution available to us, we can say, "Thanks for your hard work, but I'm already comfortable using something else."

A lot of this has already happened in our open source world. Does anyone even care about Adobe Reader on Linux? Does anyone really depend on CyberLink's Power2Go DVD player, any longer? There are many other examples, where the community did not wait for Windows-friendly brands to come up with their Linux versions. If Adobe stops releasing the latest Flash versions for Linux, the chances are, that by the time someone puts some sense back into those at Adobe, people would have switched to something else.

Anyway, so where is this leading to?

The good news—we don't need to wait for Google to do us the favour, thanks to the recent announcement from the Pidgin project team. Their latest version 2.6.1 has "added XMPP Voice and Video support." You will now be able to connect with Gmail's voice and video chat users from the Linux world too. According to Pidgin's changelog, "Voice and video support with

Jingle (XEP-0166, 0167, 0176, & 0177), voice support with GTalk and voice and video support with the Gmail Web client..." have been added in version 2.6.0—the following version (2.6.1) was released the same day with a few bug fixes.

Now, this is a real winner on the desktop Linux front. Another excuse not to switch to Linux has been deftly taken down by smart open source developers. Certainly a development that's enabled the 'perfect

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desktop' to seem more 'perfect'.

Somehow this reminds me of that Chumbawamba song that was pretty popular during the 1998 Football World Cup: "I get knocked down. But, I get up again. You're never going to keep me down." Don't get me wrong. I don't in any way imply that we're playing catch up in all fields. In fact, we're pretty much ahead on most fronts. Yet, let's figure out our shortcomings, and then Conquer.

With that, I rest my case while you enjoy the 'perfect desktop', which is by no means perfect but will certainly make Vista users go green with envy.

Best Wishes!



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